

MULTIMEDIA TIME

Linux is as efficient a tool as Windows when it comes to multimedia files, and you can have your music players, VCD players, encoders and rippers for the Linux platform too

Ripping CDs to your hard disk

A very efficient tool for extracting songs from audio CDs and transferring them to your hard disk or converting them to MP3s is grip (available for download from www.nostatic.org/grip). grip is based on GTK and can also be used as a CD-player. It provides a front-end using which you can directly convert the extracted audio to MP3.

For these purposes you might want to use a free encoder such as bladeenc (check out <http://bladeenc.mp3.no/>) that uses similar compression routines as that of mpegEnc. Open grip and select the **Config > MP3** option and point the encoder to bladeenc. Start the extraction process and you have your MP3s. grip has the ripping capabilities of cdparanoia built-in and facilitates the use of other external rippers.

Playing Ogg Vorbis files

If you think MP3 is passe and Ogg Vorbis is in, you definitely want support for this format. Well, you can install plugins and libraries for Linux that will allow xmms to play Ogg Vorbis files. Alternately, you can download FreeAMP 2.1 that has built-in support for Ogg Vorbis (download it from www.freeamp.org). Before playing Ogg Vorbis files though, you need to ensure that certain libraries are installed. You can find the libraries from www.vorbis.com, the official site for Ogg Vorbis.

Converting MP3/Ogg Vorbis files to Wav

Wonder why you would ever want to do that. But if you are so inclined, you can use FreeAMP to convert MP3/Ogg Vorbis files to Wav using the WaveoutPMO output plugin. You will have to select the plugin from the Plugins panel in the Options menu. So, whenever you play an

MP3 file after having selected the Wave-outPMO plugin the song automatically gets decoded to Wav format in the MyMusic directory.

Creating a playlist of all MP3s

Instead of adding individual MP3 files to the playlist in xmmms, why not just add all of them to the playlist? A simple method is to use the command `locate .mp3 > /path/to/playlistname`. I

If you want to make a playlist of all the MP3 songs on a CD, you can use the command `/mnt/cdrom -name *.mp3 -print >> allthesongs.list`. Here a file called `allthesongs.list` is created that acts as a playlist for `xmms` or even `x11amp` for that matter.



You can play DivX in addition to playing music in xmms

Playing DivX with xmms-l

Installing the DivX 3.11 alpha codec for working with xmm5 tends to be a problem. To ease your task, this is the step-by-step method to install the DivX Codec.

First, install a lot of RPMs that you might find at the following locations:

- www.xmms.org/files/1.2.x/rpm/rh7.x/xmms-1.2.5-1.i386.rpm
- www.xmms.org/files/1.2.x/rpm/rh7.x/xmms-devel-1.2.5-1.i386.rpm
- [ftp://ftp.rpfind.net/linux/sourceforge/linuxrpms/avifile-0.53.5-1mdk.i586.rpm](http://ftp.rpfind.net/linux/sourceforge/linuxrpms/avifile-0.53.5-1mdk.i586.rpm)

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ftp://ftp.rpmfind.net/linux/redhat/7.1/en/os/i386/Re
dHat/RPMS/glib-1.2.9-1.i386.rpm
ftp://ftp.rpmfind.net/linux/redhat/7.1/en/os/i386/Re
dHat/RPMS/glib-devel-1.2.9-1.i386.rpm
ftp://ftp.rpmfind.net/linux/redhat/7.1/en/os/i386/Re
dHat/RPMS/SDL-1.1.7-3.i386.rpm
ftp://ftp.rpmfind.net/linux/redhat/7.1/en/os/i386/Re
dHat/RPMS/SDL-devel-1.1.7-3.i386.rpm
```

After this it is time to get the AVI plugins for xmms from <http://www.xmms.org/files/plugins/avi-xmms/avi-xmms-1.2.2.tar.gz>.

You will have to build this plugin, using the standard `configure`, `make` and `make install` commands. You also need two Windows files for the DivX 3.11 alpha codec, so copy the following from the Windows partition or another Windows machine into the `usr/lib/win32` directory:

C:\Windows\System\divxc32.dll
C:\Windows\System\divxa32.acm

Once you have done this, you should be able to play a DivX file using `xmms`.

 Playing DivX in Linux-II

An alternative method to the one outlined above is to use a software called xmps (available at <http://xmps.sourceforge.net/>). With this software you can play DivX 3.11 files, (after installing the Win32 plugin that will use the Windows files mentioned above). At the same time, by installing a plugin you can also view Open DivX files. To use xmps, install the rpms, and then download the win32 plugin first and do a configure, make and make install. Then open xmps, go to the Video Codecs option, select win32 and specify the path where the Windows dlls are located (by default it is in /usr/lib/win32). You may have to be logged in as root for the installation to work. For making OpenDivX work, you will need the Linux decoder from the Project Mayo site. 

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